

someone with a professional degree averages four times more than someone with a high school diploma.

Brent's dad Walter had an undergraduate degree and always preached to Brent the value of going to college. Over the years, Walter had been passed over for promotions three times by people who were less qualified but had higher degrees. These disappointments frustrated him and he wished he had stayed in school longer. Walter didn't want his son to miss out on advancement opportunities, so he encouraged Brent to go to college.

However, his son did not share Walter's dream. Brent, at eighteen, thought college was a waste of time when the alternative was to earn "big bucks" immediately. His older brother was a starving student, and Brent did not find that lifestyle attractive. He didn't believe that a college degree had anything to do with making money, Brent's No. 1 priority was "a well-paying job." In fact, 81 percent of teen males chose "a well-paying job" as their number one future goal, according to *Men's Health*.

Brent began by selling health club memberships at a new fitness club. He made good money because he was paid a commission on each person he enrolled. The new members joined since this neighborhood had been underserved before; the closest gym had been a twenty-minute drive away. As the new members flocked to the club, Brent saw his paycheck get bigger and bigger, reinforcing his belief that he had made the right decision in choosing not to go to college. He would be studying and writing term papers right now instead of earning and spending money.

The good times did not last forever. As the club became saturated with new members, the new enrollees dwindled along with Brent's paycheck. His income leveled out to an amount that was far below what he felt he deserved to make. So Brent quit and

